

DVD-18: Dual-layered, double-sided DVDs with a capacity of about 18 GB

DVD-R and DVD+R: A DVD disc that can be written to once, the + and - stand for the different formats supported by different DVD manufacturing conglomerates

DVD-RW, DVD+RW: A re-writable disc similar to CD-RWs, where data can be written and then erased and rewritten

DVD-RAM: A now outdated re-writable disc that needs a special hardware recorder. DVD-RAM discs generally come enclosed in plastic cassettes with a sliding opening that gives access to the disc-much like a floppy

Single-layer: A DVD disc that has only one writeable layer per writeable side. Data is “burnt” onto this layer using a laser when storing data

Dual-layer: A DVD disc that has two writeable layers per writeable side, effectively doubling the capacity of the disc as compared to normal single-layer DVDs

DVD-Video: This is the most common usage of DVDs today, and is almost always what people relate the word DVD with. A DVD movie disc is an example of a DVD-Video disc

DVD-Audio: A relatively new form of audio discs that can contain 5.1 channel sound, instead of the normal stereo sound of CDs. These discs contain high definition, high bit-rate audio that has been recorded in true surround (5.1 channel). Though still rare, this format is likely to grow more popular as more audio is recorded for DVD-Audio distribution

DVD Region Code: Every DVD disc can be coded specifically for use only in a particular geographical region. In order to assist this, DVDs can be region coded.